

« Glad we could give Rahul sir a memorable farewell by winning the T20 World Cup »

ARSHDEEP SINGH

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Navigating the winding lanes of NRI Colony on the outskirts of Mohali can be overwhelming for a first-timer. However, as you stroll through the calm and quiet locality, you'll come across a three-storey building that houses the Aulakh family. While we waited outside the residence, Arshdeep Singh—India's young fast-bowling talent and an architect of the historic T20 World Cup win—walked up to open the gate. *"Dhoondhne mein mushkil toh nahi hai?"* (Did you have difficulty finding the place?) he asked.

As we entered the drawing room, we were greeted by his trophy cabinet and a framed India U-19 jersey. Since returning home, Arshdeep hasn't slept much due to jet lag, but his parents, Darshan Singh and Daljeet Kaur, have ensured their younger son gets all the 'home-cooked food' he was craving while on tour. "I love the *rajma chawal* that my mom cooks," Arshdeep said with a smile, as we started our conversation over a cup

of cardamom tea and some local savouries.

Let's begin by talking about your preparations for the T20 World Cup.

The process started early. We had conversations with the captain and the coach about approaching the tournament. After that, it was all about understanding how to adjust to the conditions and play according to the situation. Leading up to the World Cup, we had a couple of home series in which we bowled many slower balls. We did not think about what was happening (the outcome) in that particular series. Bowling those slower deliveries helped us understand which areas needed work before we played on those surfaces (in the US and the West

Indies). A lot of credit goes to the coaching staff and the captain for preparing us this way.

How did you adjust your training to handle the different conditions in the US and the Caribbean?

Acclimating to the new time zone was tough due to jet lag, but our strength and conditioning team, physios, and coaching staff did a fantastic job getting us ready during practice sessions. These sessions were competitive and match-based, allowing us to utilise the available facilities effectively. Knowing that the US wickets favoured fast bowlers, we focused on hitting the right areas. After a few sessions, we had a clear plan and were ready to execute it.

What are your thoughts on the



I dream of donning the whites and bowling with that red cherry. I want to play all three formats.